



Medicare Annual Readiness for Techs

2026-2027 Edition



Overview

A predetermination review takes place when the Provider/Member has requested a future year coverage determination in advance

- Predetermination reviews begin October 15th – December 31st of each year for all accounts that are effective January 1st of the next year
 - Prior authorization requests may be received prior to the member's coverage being active. Predetermination reviews should only be performed for applicable clients during the predetermination period. The Prior Authorization department will not perform predetermination reviews outside of this period
 - For Example: If the member's account becomes active on January 1st and a request was sent in on October 3rd, the request would be cancelled as Not Yet Eligible
- Between 10/15 thru 12/31, requests for members who are NOT found in PANDA will be cancelled as "member not found" and will not be tracked (this includes new Book 1 clients).
 - After 10/15, if a new member is found in PANDA with future year eligibility (i.e., only future eligibility exists), accept that all requests for that member are predetermination requests. Be sure to select the pre-benefit determination flag and notate in the Call Detail as described in this training video.



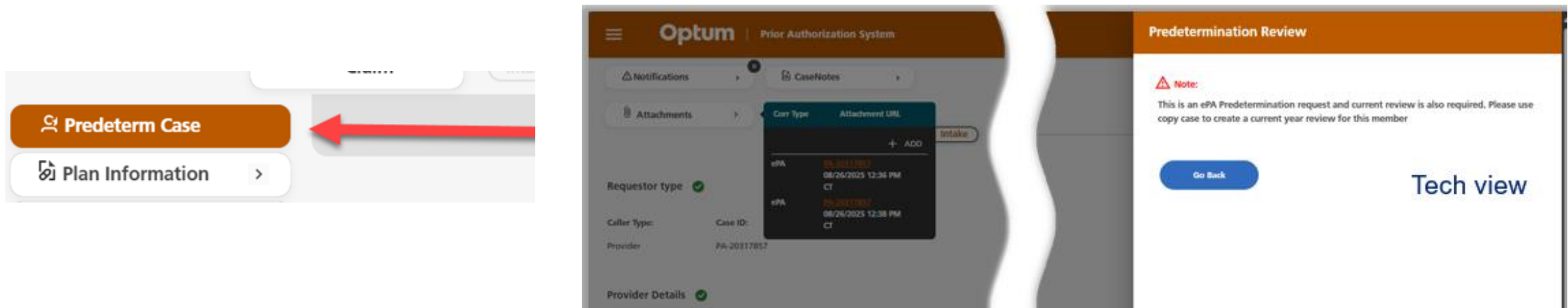
- **MASSCO Medicaid with the carrier code MPDMACSP will follow the predetermination processes outlined in this job aid.**
- **Unless otherwise specified in this job aid, Book A clients do not allow for predetermination review. Do not select the Pre-benefit Determination flag for Book A clients that do not allow for predetermination review.**
- **The predetermination reviews outside of the predetermination period logic does not apply to members with a Business Segment of UHCMR MAPD & PDP in PAS. For more information on this, reference the UHCM&R Non-Annual Enrollment Period (AEP) Reviews section of the [Medicare Overview for Techs Job Aid](#).**



Determining if a Predetermination is Being Requested – ePA Requests

In order to receive a predetermination review, the provider or member must specifically request a predetermination review (i.e., agents should not solicit predetermination reviews). If a predetermination review is not specifically requested, agents should proceed with entering the request **per standard current year processes**.

- Beginning 10/15, the ePA portal will accept predetermination requests. When the provider indicates that the request is a predetermination request (i.e., the request is for 2027), the system will determine if a current year review is required and proceed with the review accordingly.
- Upon opening a predetermination ePA case, there will be an ALERT notifying the agent on how to handle the current year review. After closing the notification, the technician will also see the predetermination flag on the ePA case.



If an ePA case indicates that the request is a predetermination request and the Pre-benefit determination flag has not been selected, the case must be reworked and the Pre-benefit Determination box checked.



Determining if a Predetermination is Being Requested – Fax Requests

In order to receive a predetermination review, the provider or member must specifically request a predetermination review (i.e., **agents should not solicit predetermination reviews**). If a predetermination review is not specifically requested, agents should proceed with entering the request **per standard current year processes**.

- Check all images for indications of a predetermination request.

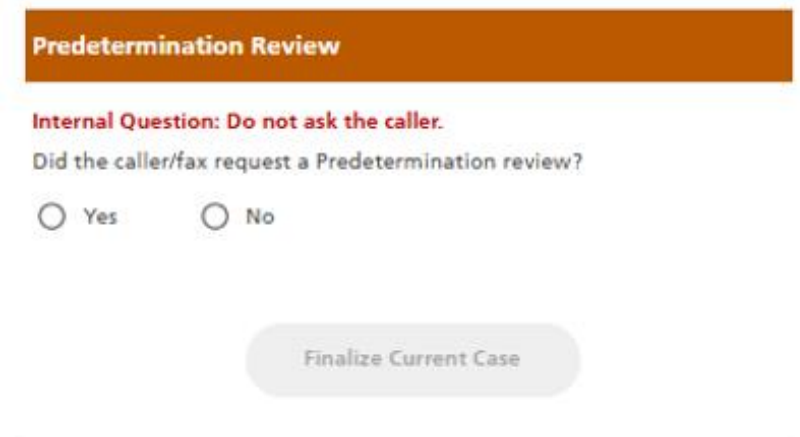


Determining if a Predetermination is Being Requested – Phone Requests

Callers must state that they are requesting a future year review for a phone request to be considered a predetermination request (i.e., **agents should not ask the caller if the request is a predetermination review**).

○ Member Initiated Requests

- Listen for any indication of a predetermination review as you are working through this member call.
- PANDA will always guide the tech to work the call under the current year review first
- When the member's plan is eligible for predetermination review, PANDA will present the predetermination screen overlay.
 - If the member indicates for future year review, answer "Yes" to the question.
 - The system will automatically generate a predetermination case that stays in your worklist.
- Complete the current year review and then finish the future year request via standard process.
- If a provider response is received without indicating a current year review is being requested, the case will be automatically entered on the current year account.
 - The initial duplicate screen will then show the duplicate PreD MPA, when this happens agents should answer "Yes" to the predetermination question.



The screenshot shows a software interface for a 'Predetermination Review'. At the top is a dark orange header with the text 'Predetermination Review'. Below this, in red text, is an 'Internal Question: Do not ask the caller.' followed by the question 'Did the caller/fax request a Predetermination review?'. There are two radio button options: 'Yes' and 'No'. At the bottom of the overlay is a light gray button labeled 'Finalize Current Case'.



Determining if a Predetermination is Being Requested – Inquiry Flow

Callers must state that they are requesting a future year review for a phone request to be considered a predetermination request (i.e., agents should **not** ask the caller if the request is a predetermination review).

- Create INQ per normal process
- When closing out the inquiry after selecting the inquiry flow (be sure to update the inquiry verbiage), the following INQ Termination Reason Codes will alert the agent with the predetermination overlay, asking “Did the caller/fax request a Predetermination review?”, Answer “Yes” only if the caller has requested a Predetermination review.
 - Resolved-approved
 - Resolved-approved edits required
 - Resolved-denied
- Select the “Finalize Current Case” option
 - If “Yes” was answered in the overlay, PANDA will create the future year request and provide the new case number that was created
 - Take control of the future year case that was created and proceed per standard processes
 - If “No” was answered in the overlay, no future year request will be created.

Inquiry Case Review

Predetermination Review

Internal Question: Do not ask the caller.
Did the caller/fax request a Predetermination review?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Finalize Current Case

Note: Are you sure you want to close your Inquiry?

Inquiry Case Summary

Case ID:
INQ-U116717

Reason Code:
Status Check-Denied

Finalize Cancel



Entering Predetermination Requests

Predetermination requests may be received via phone calls, standard PA request fax forms, Member Initiated requests, ePA and the web (through the web portal). Follow the steps outlined below when receiving a predetermination request:

- PANDA will guide users to always select the current year account first to ensure there are no access to care issues for the member currently
 - Once current year has been addressed, agents can continue with the predetermination request
- For requests entered on a member's current coverage because the future coverage is not yet loaded, Continue the request and pend to RPH, RPH will perform (e.g., formulary crosswalk, future year formulary lookup) to determine if there is a PA requirement for the future year.
- The Pre-benefit Determination flag is only visible on current accounts that do not have future year coverage.
 - Notice that when the Pre-benefit Determination flag is selected that the Req PA Start Date will default to 1/1/2027 and cannot be changed.

Pre-Benefit
Determination
flag visible

Case Details

Cost Reduction: ☒ Yes ☐ No

What drug are you selecting? ☒ Brand ☐ Generic

Pre-Benefit Determination: ☒ Yes ☐ No

Medication Start Date: 01/01/2027

Pre-Benefit
Determination
flag NOT visible

Case Details

Cost Reduction: ☐ Yes ☐ No

What drug are you selecting? ☐ Brand ☐ Generic

Directions For Use: Type Here

Dispensed Qty: 30

Days Supply: 30

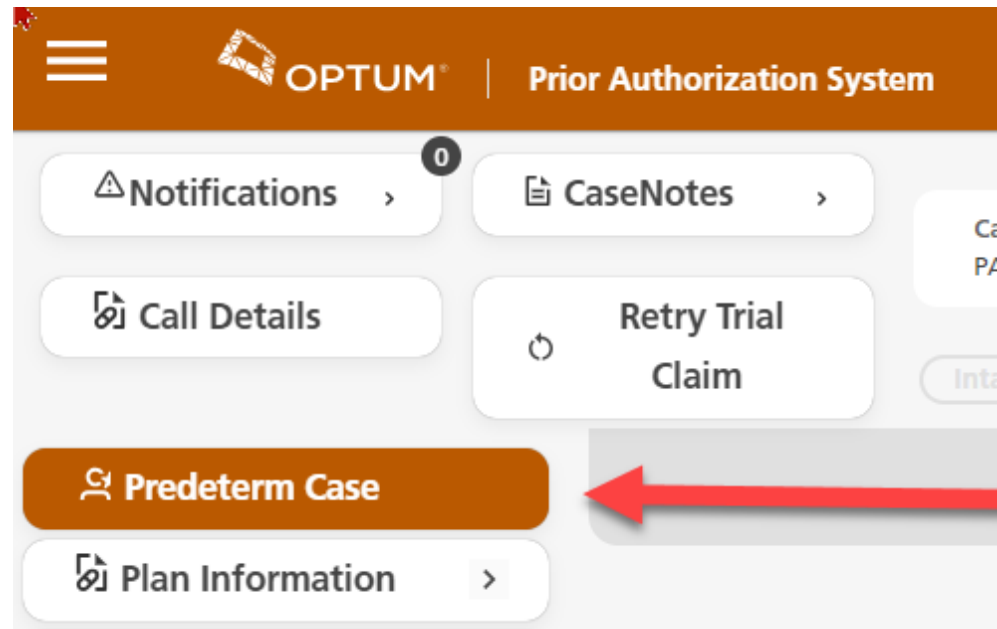
Site of Administration: Select Value

Submit



How to Identify Predetermination Requests

Once the predetermination flag has been selected, PANDA will display an orange header alert on the left-hand panel of the agent's screen. If the orange alert is present, the case is a predetermination request, and the future year guidelines will be used to review the case. The medication start date would also default to 1/1/2027.



○ Predetermination Addendum

- The predetermination addendum will automatically be placed on letters for all predetermination requests (e.g., approvals, denials, cancellations).



Predetermination Requests Received Prior to 10/15

The prior authorization department cannot accept predetermination request prior to 10/15/2026. If a predetermination request is received prior to 10/15, please follow the steps outlined below:

- Cancel the case as Not Yet Eligible. No tracking will be required. The member/provider will need to resubmit the case on or after 10/15.
- This does not apply to members without current coverage and with a Business Segment of UHCMR MAPD & PDP in PANDA. For these members, reference the UHCM&R Non-Annual Enrollment Period (AEP) Reviews section of the Medicare Overview for Techs Job Aid.

See the Book A Predetermination Reviews section below for information on Book A predetermination requests received before predetermination review is allowed.



Call Scripting for Predetermination Requests Prior to 10/15

The prior authorization department cannot accept predetermination request prior to 10/15/2026. If a phone predetermination request is received prior to 10/15, please use the suggested scripting below:

Member Requests:

"For your convenience, the Prior Authorization Department will begin to review pre-benefit determinations for 2027 on October 15th. We will not be able to hold or accept requests until that day. Either you or your provider can call back on or after October 15th and we will be happy to process your request."

Provider Requests:

"For your convenience, the Prior Authorization Department will begin to review pre-benefit determinations for 2027 on October 15th. We will not be able to hold or accept requests until that day. Please call back on or after October 15th and we will be happy to process your request."

Knowledge Check #1

Q: When does predetermination period start?

A: 10/15/2026

Q: Anytime a predetermination request is received, what are you required to do on the case?

A: PANDA will ensure the agent work the case through the Current YR account first. Agent must answer the predetermination question “Did the caller/fax request a predetermination review?” when presented to you, if answered “YES.” Then, the system will auto-create the Predetermination case.

Q: The system will always check the Pre-benefit determination radio selection when a predetermination case is created. Why is it important to not accidentally turn off the Pre-benefit flag?

A: To ensure the start date of the case reflects 1/1/future year

A: To ensure future year criteria is utilized for review

Q: If a fax request is received with a previous year predetermination box checked, is it a valid predetermination request?

A: Yes! Even if the form itself indicates predetermination for a previous year

Q: If a predetermination request is received and the member does not have future coverage, what action must be taken?

A: PANDA will ensure the agent work the case through the Current YR account first. The predetermination question “Did the caller/fax request a predetermination review?” will be presented to you, Answer it as “YES.” Then, the system will auto-create the Predetermination case under the Current Year Account.

Selecting Correct Member Coverage

Selecting the correct member coverage prior to 10/15:

- Until the predetermination period begins, agents should only select current member accounts when current and future coverages are located
 - As a reminder, the current coverage will reflect 'Current' in the “Elig Status column”

Effective Start Date	Effective End Date	Eligibility Status
01/01/2024	09/30/2024	Current

10/01/2024	12/31/2024	Future
------------	------------	--------

Predetermination Review

Internal Question: Do not ask the caller.

Did the caller/fax request a Predetermination review?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Finalize Current Case

Selecting the correct member coverage after 10/15:

- During the predetermination period, PANDA will automatically perform a name and DOB search to identify all active/future accounts for the member (As a reminder, three identifiers are required to validate member for all cases to be processed.)
- If a current and future year account are returned as shown in the chart to the left, please follow the steps below:
 - PANDA will automatically select the current year coverage as the primary account. This will ensure that the current year coverage is addressed first.
 - Predetermination requests: Answer YES to the predetermination overlay after clinical guidelines in the current year review. Panda will create the future year review for you. Take control of the future year review case and process accordingly.
 - The future coverage account will have an effective start date of 1/1/2027 and an “Elig Status” of Future.

Predetermination
Overlay

ePA Requests for Members with Multiple Coverages in Same Benefit Year

If a member has multiple coverages in the same benefit year as the request is being made (e.g., 2026 MAO and 2026 PDP), the request will route to a technician to select the correct coverage.

- Technicians will be presented with coverage from the benefit year the request is being worked under (i.e., if current year, presented with 2026 coverage only).
- Reference the ePA for Techs Job Aid on how to handle multiple accounts on ePA requests



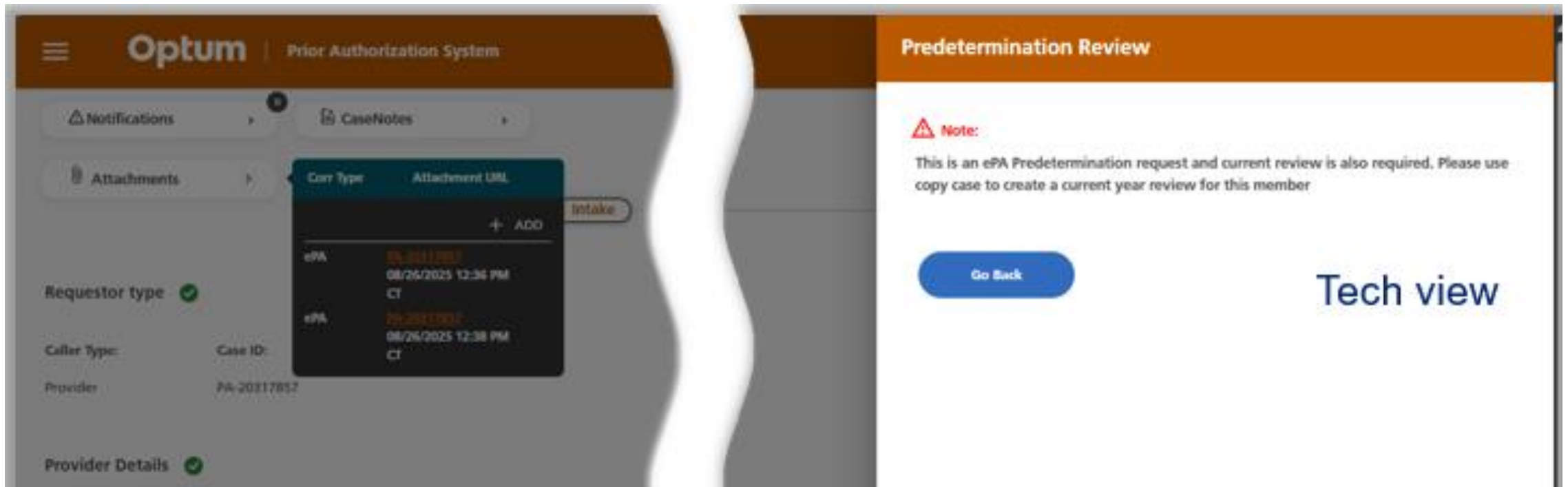
WARNING: Failure to follow this process will result in immediate disciplinary action following the IRE Related Behaviors policy. If you have questions regarding this process, please reach out to your supervisor immediately to ensure understanding.

Step	Action
1	Refer to the Select Member sections of the Case Processing Job Aid for details on selecting the correct account and when a case is needed or not needed on additional accounts.
2	If alternative coverage is found, is there a case on the other account? • Yes: No action is required on the other account. Continue your case for the account that was populated per the standard process. • No: Continue the case for the current account AND create a case on the alternative coverage, if needed and proceed to step 3.
3	• If the technician selects a member from a market for which they are skilled to work, the technician will continue to work the case through following standard process. • If the technician selects a member from a market for which they are NOT skilled to work, complete the following: ◦ The case will route to the InBoundCorrWB. The technician may view the case in read-only to use the Copy Case function to enter a second case for the member's alternative account. If the copy case function is not available, then the technician must rework the case manually. Please refer to the Reworking Cases section of the Correcting Case Errors and Manual Tracking Job Aid. • If a general PA technician receives an ePA for a member with two dedicated carrier accounts, it is still the responsibility of that technician to ensure that all accounts are addressed. ◦ Complete the case for one of the two dedicated accounts, then create a second case for the alternate account. ◦ The copied case will NOT automatically route out of the technician's workbasket so the technician must request to have the case transferred to a dedicated agent.

ePA Predetermination Requests

If an ePA is received where the future year coverage is requested and **there is no denial on file**, PANDA will alert technicians with the overlay below and they must follow the directions outlined in the alert:

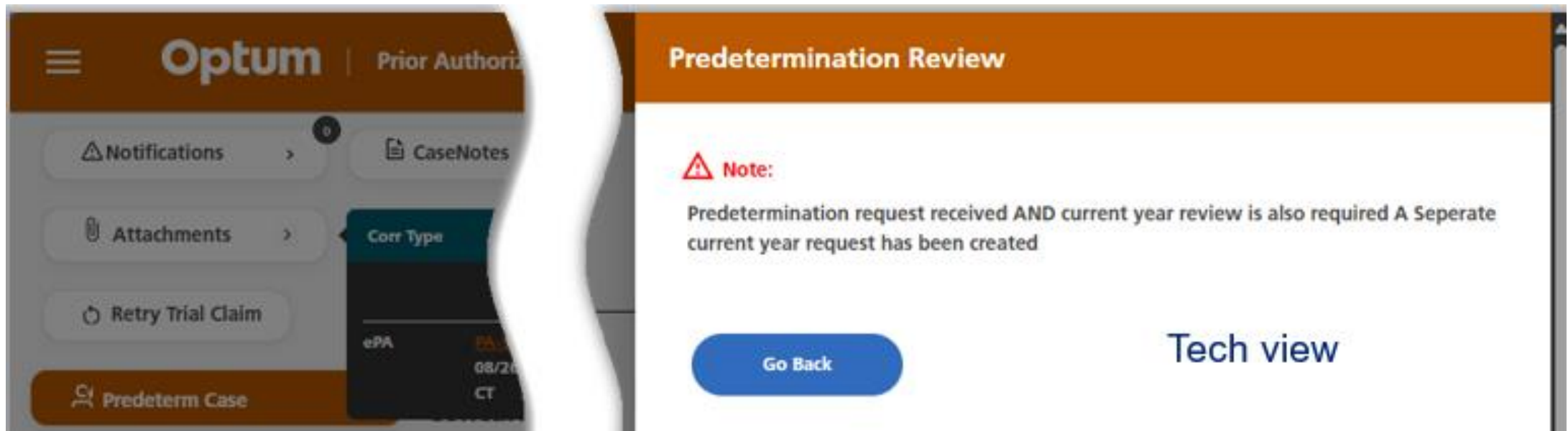
- Complete future year request.
- Copy case to create current year request and complete it per standard process.



ePA Predetermination Requests cont'd

If an ePA is received where the future year coverage is requested and **there is a denial on file**, PANDA will alert technicians with the overlay below and they must follow the directions outlined in the alert:

- PANDA will automatically create a case on the current account
- Complete the future year request.
- Take control of current year request that the system created and complete it per standard process.



ePA Predetermination Requests cont'd

If an ePA is received where the future year coverage is requested and **there is no current year coverage on file**, PANDA will alert technicians with the overlay below and they must follow the directions outlined in the alert:

- Complete the future year request
- No further action is required

SLA Compliance:	Quoted	Case	Primary	Multiple
09/07/2025 11:48	TAT:	Type:	PA:	PA:
AM CT	4 days	PA	PAReqd	

1 of 1

Predetermination Review

 **Note:**

Alert: No current year on file coverage defaults to future year. No need to check or create a case for current year coverage.

[Go Back](#)

Merging Cases

When merging cases agents will be able to see both current and future accounts. However, agents will only be able to merge requests for the same coverage year (i.e., while agents can see both current and future coverage, they cannot merge future year requests with current year requests or vice versa).

Case Duplicates								
Select	Case Status	Case Id	Eligibility Profile	Pre-Benefit Determination	Program	NDC	GPI	Drug Name
☒	Open-InProcess	PA-C2020989	Current			50419054001	30354030000310	Kerendia Tab 10mg

1 of 1

MergeContinue With the Case

Can't merge this case with selected case - Eligibility profile is different.

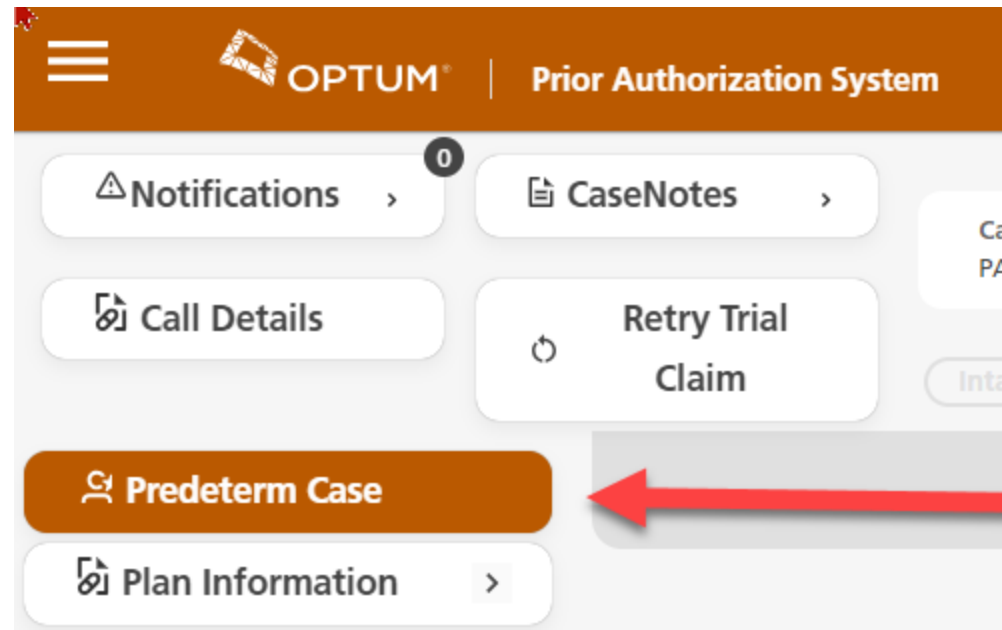
Carrier Code:	SLA Compliance:	Quoted TAT:	Case Type:	Primary PA:	Multiple PA:
MPDOVA	09/28/2025 1:11 PM CT	72 hours	PA	PAReqd	

Action

Response to a Predetermination MPA

When merging a provider's response with an MPA request you must check to see if the MPA is a predetermination request. The provider's response may not indicate that a future year review is requested; however, it may be the response to a future year member-initiated request. Please check the Case Notes as well as the Predeterm orange alert for any indication that a predetermination review was requested.

If this field indicates that the MPA is a predetermination request, proceed with the review using the appropriate future year tools. Additionally, consider if a current year case needs to be entered. Cancelling a case as no PA required when a review is needed is considered a compliance risk.



Current Year UM Criteria Check

When a predetermination request is received, agents must start with current year review to determine if current year UM criteria exists – meaning, you must complete or cancel current year review before system will allow you to enter a request for predetermination review via overlay (an exception to this process exists for ePA cases).

- For requests with a denial on file, technicians must answer the GuideME questions and follow the GuideME prompts.
 - Use the Review vs. Appeal chart to double check the GuideME's prompts to ensure if the case should be reviewed or sent to Appeals.
- The predetermination flag should **ONLY** be selected when the case is intended to be reviewed for predetermination

Future Year TCSE Requests

When a tier cost sharing exception (TCSE) predetermination request for a member is received, agents must start with current year TCSE review, following standard processes. Once the current year TCSE case is completed or canceled the agent will be presented with an overlay asking if request is for predetermination, select yes. The system will create the future year request, grab control of that created case and follow normal processes.

Non-ePA Cases (Phone / Fax / Web)

For non-ePA requests, PANDA will default to the current year account and technicians will continue the review per standard processes

- For current year review, ensure Formulary Card/Formulary Look Up and trial claim is referenced to determine if review is necessary
 - **If review is required:** proceed per standard current year review process
 - **If no review is required:** after ensuring successful trial claim, proceed to cancel your case per standard current year review process
- Once current year case is completed or canceled, the agent will be presented with an overlay asking if the request is for predetermination, select yes (**only if the Phone/Fax/Web case has requested future year review**). The system will create the future year request. Grab control of that created case and follow normal processes.

Formulary Details

Selected Drug:

LEQVIO SOL

Generic Name:

INCLISIRAN SODIUM SUBCUTANEOUS SOLN PREF SYR 284 MG/1.5ML

Formulary Code:

O25MCORE

Formulary Tier:

95

Clinical Program and Customer Service Notes:

Agent Notes:

No

QTY Limit:

Yes. 4.50 per 180 day(s).

Member Notes:

No

Step Therapy:

No

Brand Name:

LEQVIO

Formulary Name:

25002 MAPD CORE (MCORE)

Formulary Status:

Non-Formulary

PA Required:

No

Part B vs Part D Determination Required:

No

CMS Drug Type:

Brand

Predetermination Review

Internal Question: Do not ask the caller.

Did the caller/fax request a Predetermination review?

☐ Yes

☐ No

Finalize Current Case

Knowledge Check #2

Q: True or False: In order to merge with a predetermination MPA, the providers response must also specify predetermination review

A: False – the providers response may not specify predetermination is requested however, you must still merge with the pending MPA, check the Call Detail note, notes, and if there is an indication of predetermination review, you must also ensure the pre-benefit determination flag is checked

Q: If a predetermination request is received for a member who only has current year coverage, can the request still be taken in?

A: Yes! Select the members current account and proceed through review when presented with overlay asking if the request is for predetermination, select YES. Panda will create the future year request, take control of the future year and follow standard processes.

Q: True or False: When a predetermination review is requested for a phone or fax case, you must also ensure there is no current year review required

A: True

Q: For ePA, when will you be required to conduct both a current and a future year review?

A: Only when the overlay instructs you to do so.

Trial Claims

- Predetermination requests approved under the current year eligibility because the future year eligibility is not yet loaded will have the trial claims processed by the Edit Team. These cases must be routed to the edit team in PAS by selecting Predetermination Trial Claim.
- Future year requests that are entered on a member's future year eligibility will have a trial claim processed on the member's future year coverage in PANDA. If the trial claim is not successful, reach out to your leadership. Your leadership will then route the case to the Edit Team in PAS by selecting Predetermination Trial Claim.

Log Edit Team

**** Please Enter Required Fields Before Submit**

Case Number

Case Create Timestamp

Business Segment

Site *

Feedback

SLA Timestamp

Priority *

Carrier Codes

Task *

Predetermination Trial Claim

Notes *

Escalation

Submit

Predetermination Requests Urgency & Turnaround Times

Predetermination requests will continue to follow the existing process for urgency. Processes include:



Business Process	Steps
Indexing	Indexers will index predetermination requests under the current year account with applicable urgency type. Please refer to the Handling Fax Requests Job Aid for further instructions on handling predetermination requests.
Fax, Phone, or Member-Initiated Request	Fax/phone/MPA Outreach agents will work all requests under the member's current year account if available with applicable urgency type ; otherwise, the future year account will be selected. Follow standard processes.

Predetermination Requests Urgency & Turnaround Times – Talking Points

When will I receive a decision on my request?

Once we receive supporting documentation, you may receive a decision between 24-72 hours for standard requests and within 24 hours for urgent requests.

If approved, when will my medication coverage begin?

Coverage granted through a predetermination request will not be effective until January 1st, 2027. Remember a predetermination request is for the 2027 benefit year.

If denied, will I be denied my medication?

Regardless of a predetermination request denial, your plan may allow you a transitional supply while your doctor requests an appeal of the decision. If transition is allowed, the first transaction of the new benefit year will process for a maximum of 31 days' supply. If the transaction is denied, your pharmacy may contact the Help Desk department for assistance in processing, or Member Services for further details.

If denied, am I allowed to request an appeal? When can I request it?

Upon denial you are granted appeals rights. The appropriate time for you to exercise your rights is dependent on the date of your case submission.

Tech Note: Please refer to the [Review vs. Appeals](#) Grid.

I have not enrolled in a Medicare plan. Can my doctor submit my request now?

No, OptumRx is unable to review a request if your enrollment information is not finalized. If your enrollment is not finalized, OptumRx is unable to view or determine your benefits to decide if a PA is required. Once you have enrolled in a participating plan, you may contact your member services to determine when your benefits are viewable by OptumRx and when your doctor can submit the PA request.

Review vs. Appeals

The chart below does NOT apply to IBC Medicare or Fallon Medicare. Fallon cases with a denial on file within 65 days follow standard phone and fax processes regardless of the calendar year.

First Denied Request Received within Past 65 Days	Second Request for the Same Drug	ACTION: Review the Case or Send to Appeals
2026 request denied in 2026	2026 request reviewed in 2026 	Appeal
2026 request denied in 2026	2026 request reviewed in 2027	Review*
2026 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Review*
2026 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2026	Review
2026 request denied in 2027	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Review
2027 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2026 	Appeal
2027 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Review*
2027 request denied in 2027	2027 request reviewed in 2027 	Appeal

For action items marked with an asterisk (*), Appeal should be allowed if:

1. The request is on an appeals form or the caller/fax clearly indicates an appeal is requested; AND
2. PA confirms that the member is on the same plan.

How to Understand the Review vs. Appeals Chart

First Denied Request Received within Past 65 Days	Second Request for the Same Drug	ACTION: Review the Case or Send to Appeals	Example Scenarios
2026 request denied in 2026	2026 request reviewed in 2026	Appeal	Case A for current year review was denied on 10/15/2026. Case B for current year review was denied on 11/1/2026. Since we have a current year denial on file with Case A within 65 days, Case B must be forwarded to appeals
2026 request denied in 2026	2026 request reviewed in 2027	Review*	Case A for current year review was denied on 11/25/2026. Case B for current year review was denied on 1/1/2027. Since members get a clean slate at the start of each year, Case A is no longer considered since it was reviewed in the previous benefit year, therefore, Case B Must be reviewed. *If the 2nd review requests for an appeal, case must be forwarded to appeals
2026 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Review*	Case A for current year review was denied on 11/1/2026. Case B for current year review was denied on 1/1/2027. Since members get a clean slate at the start of each year, Case A is no longer considered since it was reviewed in the previous benefit year, therefore, Case B Must be reviewed. *If the 2nd review requests for an appeal, case must be forwarded to appeals
2026 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2026	Review	Case A for current year review was denied on 11/1/2026. Case B for future year review was denied on 11/10/2026. Since current year request and future year request are not considered duplicates and must have their own review conducted, you will proceed to review the future year request.
2026 request denied in 2027	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Review*	Case A was received on 12/28/2026 but was not denied until 1/1/2027. Case B was received on 1/3/2027 Although Case A was denied in 2027, the request was received in 2026 making the request a 2026 request. When member entered new benefit year, they received a clean slate, thus voiding the 2026 request meaning, Case B must be taken in for review. *If the 2nd review requests for an appeal, case must be forwarded to appeals.
2027 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2026	Appeal	Case A for future year review was denied on 10/30/2026 Case B is received for future year review on 11/8/2026 Since we have a future year denial on file with Case A within 65 days, Case B must be forwarded to appeals.
2027 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Review*	Case A for future year review was denied on 11/25/2026 Case B for future year review was received on 1/1/2027 Since members get a clean slate at the start of each year, Case A is no longer considered since it was reviewed in the previous benefit year, therefore, Case B Must be reviewed. *If the 2nd review requests for an appeal, case must be forwarded to appeals
2027 request denied in 2027	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Appeal	Case A was denied on 1/15/2027 Case B was received on 1/17/2027 Since we have a denial on file with Case A within 65 days, Case B must be forwarded to appeals



How to Understand the Review vs. Appeals GuideMe

- During the predetermination period, GuideMe will have additional prompts that technicians will need to answer
- These prompts will aid the user in determining Review Vs Appeals when comparing decisions on Current year coverage and Future year coverage.
 - Example: If the denial on file is for the same eligibility agents would answer Yes.
 - Denied case is for Future Year and the New case is also for Future year.

The screenshot displays the Optum Prior Authorization System interface. At the top, there's a header with the Optum logo and 'Prior Authorization System'. Below this, there are navigation tabs: 'Notifications' (with a red badge), 'CaseNotes', 'Call Details', and 'Retry Trial Claim'. A status bar shows 'Case ID: PA-1022701', 'Carrier Code: TESTPDP', 'SLA Compliance: 09/08/2024 | 5:44 PM CT', and 'Quoted TAT: 72 hours'. A progress bar at the bottom indicates 'Intake' and 'Action' steps. The main content area is titled 'Drug Information' and shows details for 'XPOVIO PAK 40MG', including NDC, GPI, MSC, Directions For Use, and Brand Or Generic. A 'TESTING' section is highlighted in pink, containing two questions: 'Is the previous denial case for the same Eligibility as the current case?' and 'Is your current Fax request attachment the same as the previous case's denial?'. Both questions have radio button options for 'Yes, this request contains the same information' and 'No, there is new or different information'. The first question's 'Yes' option is selected.

UHCM&R Diabetic Testing Supplies

- For members who do not have future year coverage loaded in PANDA, the technician should utilize the diabetic testing supplies information in PANDA for the members current year benefit and review the case with the assumption that the member's benefits will remain the same in the future year.
- After the member's future year coverage has been loaded in PANDA, the technician should utilize the following process to determine if a non-preferred testing supply review will be required in the future year.

Determining which Members Require Review

As mentioned, not all members will be subject to this review. The chart below will help you identify the MAPD and MA Only members who should undergo review.

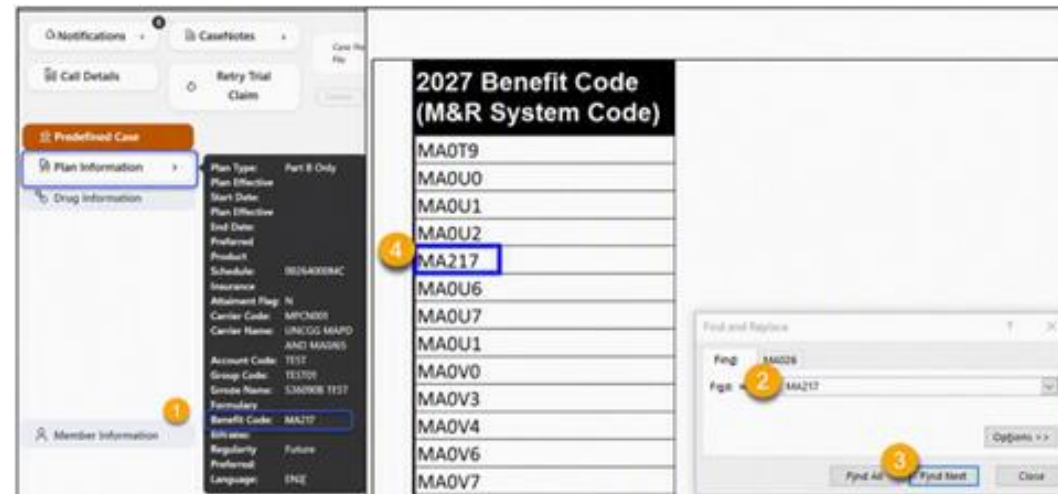
Time of Review	How to Determine if Review Applies
Any member reviewed prior to January 1st	2027 Diabetic Testing Supplies Grid
Any member reviewed after future year coverage is loaded, and future year benefit information is loaded into PANDA.	PANDA formulary information or rejection

How Does the Diabetic Testing Supply Grid Work?

During the predetermination review period, there will be instances where technicians will need to refer to the grid (retired after the predetermination period) to determine if the member will be subject to PA.

1. Locate the Benefit Code in the Plan Information tab of PANDA.
2. Use the Ctrl+F function to search for the member's Benefit Code in the grid. Ensure there are no spaces before or after the Benefit Code once you've pasted it into the search field.
3. Select Find Next.
4. If the Benefit Code is found on the grid in the RxBenefit Code column, the member is subject to review of non-preferred testing supplies in the future benefit year.

**This means you should proceed with review for predetermination*



UHCM&R Preferred Supplies

The preferred testing supplies listed in the Medicare Testing Supplies for Techs Job Aid will continue to be preferred.

Preferred Blood Glucose Monitors and Test Strips*	
Monitors	
Accu-Chek® Guide	Contour® Next Gen
Accu-Chek® Guide Me	Contour® Next One
Contour® Next Ez	Contour® Plus Blue
Test Strips	
Accu-Chek® Aviva Plus	Contour® Next
Accu-Chek® Guide	Contour® Plus
Contour®	

Knowledge Check #3

Q: For MAPD and MA Only members, how will you determine a predetermination review is required for Diabetic Testing Supplies?

A: You must use the 2027 Diabetic Testing Supplies Grid to verify if review is necessary for future year

Q: For UHCM&R what is the Diabetic preferred testing meters?

A: Accu-Check Guide, Accu-Check Guide Me, Contour Next EZ, Contour Next Gen, Contour Next One, Contour Plus Blue

Q: For UHCM&R what is the Diabetic preferred testing strips?

A: Accu-Check Aviva Plus, Accu-Check Guide, Contour, Contour Next, Contour Plus

Book A Predetermination Reviews

Unless specifically stated otherwise, Book A clients do not allow for predetermination review beginning October 15th.

- For plans that do not allow pre-determination review, PANDA will NOT present the Predetermination overlay, and technicians should NOT select the pre-benefit Determination flag.
- Additionally, if a predetermination request is received before an official predetermination period start date is communicated, the request should be canceled using the Not Yet Eligible cancel reason code (unless plan-specific verbiage is available) and the verbiage below.
 - *PA-<*> has been cancelled for <*>, use as directed, for the following reason: Pre-benefit determination reviews for the 2027 Part D benefit are not yet available for this plan. Please resubmit your prior authorization request for the 2027 benefit year beginning January 1, 2027.*
 - Remember to check for Current Year UM criteria and to follow all MPA cancellation processes if the request is an MPA.

Book A Clients Allowing Predetermination Review

The following table lists clients that have elected predetermination review and provides termination verbiage for requests that are received before the specified predetermination start date (use the Not Yet Eligible cancel reason code to cancel these requests).

Plan	Verbiage
10/15/2026	
BCBS-SC	PA-<*> has been cancelled for <*drug*>, use as directed, for the following reason: Pre-benefit determination reviews for the 2027 Part D benefit are not yet available for this plan. Please resubmit your prior authorization request for the 2027 benefit year beginning October 15, 2026.
Compass Rose	
Eternal Health	
Samaritan	
Union Pacific	
11/01/2026	
Clover Health	PA-<*> has been cancelled for <*drug*>, use as directed, for the following reason: Pre-benefit determination reviews for the 2027 Part D benefit are not yet available for this plan. Please resubmit your prior authorization request for the 2027 benefit year beginning November 1, 2026.
KelseyCare Advantage	
MPSERS	
Provider Partners Health Plan (PPHP)	
Quartz	
State of New Jersey	
12/01/2026	
AlohaCare	PA-<*> has been cancelled for <*drug*>, use as directed, for the following reason: Pre-benefit determination reviews for the 2027 Part D benefit are not yet available for this plan. Please resubmit your prior authorization request for the 2027 benefit year beginning December 1st, 2026.
BCBS-AZ	
CareOregon (CORMCARE)	
Fallon	
IBCMEDDNJ	
IBCMEDDPA	
MGBHP	
Sanford	

New Book A Medicare Clients

New Book A Medicare Clients

Plan Name	Carrier Code(s)	RxCLAIM Instance	Notes
American Postal Workers Union (APWU)	EGWPS065 EGWPS066		
Clover Health	CLO8556 CLO8712 CLO22CA		
Government of Guam			

*These plans are migrating from Book 1 to Book A. For UAW and John Deere specific processes, refer to the UAW and John Deere [section](#).

Authorization Expiration Reviews

Unless the request originated as an ePRO, follow the process outlined below for Book A Medicare clients that do not allow predetermination reviews. As a reminder, follow standard practices for cases that originated an ePRO.

- If a future year review is specifically requested, the request should be cancelled as Not Yet Eligible.
- If there is an authorization, determine if a request can be taken in by looking at the Allowed-From Reauth Date in PANDA. If the Allowed-From Reauth Date does not indicate a request can be reviewed and a secondary review is NOT requested, the request should be cancelled per standard processes.
- If there is an authorization on file and the Allowed-From Reauth Date indicates a new request can be reviewed, follow standard process to enter the request for current year review.

IBC Medicare (IBCMEDD) will allow for 2027 predetermination reviews beginning 11/01/2026. When reviewing IBC Medicare requests, keep the following in mind:

- Utilize the following chart when determining if a request should be reviewed or sent to Appeals:

First Denied Request Received within Past 60 Days	Second Request for the Same Drug	ACTION: Review the Case or Send to Appeals
2026 request denied in 2026	2026 request reviewed in 2026	Appeal
2026 request denied in 2026	2026 request reviewed in 2027	Appeal
2026 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Appeal
2026 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2026	Review
2026 request denied in 2027	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Appeal
2027 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2026	Appeal
2027 request denied in 2026	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Appeal
2027 request denied in 2027	2027 request reviewed in 2027	Appeal

- Future Year Coverage Not Found: If future year review is requested but the member does not have future year benefits loaded in PANDA, a predetermination review CANNOT be performed. In this instance, determine if current year review is required by using available tools (e.g., formulary lookup).
 - If current year review is required, proceed with the current year review under the member's current year account following standard processes and make sure the following Call Detail note is entered:
- Future year review requested. No future year account found. However, current year review also required.
 - If current year review is not required and there is no future year account loaded, the case should be cancelled as Member Not Found.

BCBS-SC Predetermination Processes

The predetermination period for BlueCross BlueShield South Carolina (BCBS-SC) begins 11/1/2026. When reviewing predetermination requests for BCBS-SC, keep the following in mind:

- BCBS-SC members may have multiple accounts with different member ID numbers. When entering cases, search for the member by name and date of birth to ensure that all accounts for that member are visible. Select the Medicare coverage instead of the Medigap plan.
- Below is an example from the 2021-2022 predetermination season

Member ID	Member Last Name	First Name	Carrier Code	Account Code	Group Code	Plan Code	EF Start Date	EF End Date	Grp EF Start Date	Grp EF End Date	Elig Status
ZH6			BXMD01A77	60000	771400003	MBXMD0200	01/01/2020	12/31/2020	01/01/2020	12/31/2020	Current
ZCF			BXG001GIO	60000	620000000	BXG120001	01/01/2021	12/31/2020	01/01/2020	12/31/2020	Future
NB0			BXMD01A78	60000	771400003	MBXMD0210	01/01/2021	12/31/2020	01/01/2021	12/31/2020	Future

Do NOT select the Medigap Plan (carrier code BXG001GIO and Plan Code BXG12001)

- A future year review cannot be performed if the member does not have future year benefits loaded. If a future year review is requested and future year benefits are not loaded, determine if a current year review is required by using available tools (e.g., formulary lookup) or if an ePRO was sent from the members current year account (refer to the Identifying ePRO Cases section of the ePRO Reviews Job Aid).
 - If an ePRO was sent, handle the request using the Handling Instructions for ePRO vs Predetermination section.
 - If a current year review is required, proceed with reviewing under the member's current year account, following standard current year processes. Add the following Call Detail note to the current year case:

Subject: Future Year Review Request

Body: Future year review requested. No future year account found. However, current year review also required.

- If a current year review is not required and there is no future year account loaded, the case should be cancelled as Member Not Found. Add the following Call Detail note to the cancelled case:

Subject: Future Year Review Request

Body: Future year review requested; no future year benefits loaded. Current year review not required.

Thank you for the continued support and collaboration as we continue to strive for IRE prevention!



Optum is a registered trademark of Optum, Inc. in the U.S. and other jurisdictions. All other brand or product names are the property of their respective owners. Because we are continuously improving our products and services, Optum reserves the right to change specifications without prior notice. Optum is an equal opportunity employer.

© 2022 Optum, Inc. All rights reserved.

